

B $\flat$ Blues

12-bar practice chart
Written for B $\flat$ trumpet

A flexible form for learning the blues by ear. Large symbols are written for trumpet;
concert chords appear below. Start with roots, then guide tones, then make a melody.

Chorus — written chords

C7 concert B $\flat$ 7	F7 concert E $\flat$ 7	C7 concert B $\flat$ 7	C7 concert B $\flat$ 7
F7 concert E $\flat$ 7	F$\sharp$°7 concert E°7	C7 concert B $\flat$ 7	A7 concert G7
Dm7 concert Cm7	G7 concert F7	C7 A7 concert B $\flat$ 7 / G7	Dm7 G7 concert Cm7 / F7

Sound palette

Written C blues: C · E $\flat$ · F · G $\flat$ · G · B $\flat$

Guide tones: 3rds and 7ths

Four useful passes

- ☐ Roots only; make the time feel good
- ☐ 3rds and 7ths with smooth voice leading
- ☐ One rhythmic idea through all 12 bars
- ☐ Sing a phrase, then answer it on trumpet

Practice notes
